

Beguni

VEGETARIAN · NO ONION · NO GARLIC · NO ALLIUM · NO ALUMINIUM

SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	10 min	15 min	25 min

Cookware: Steel kadhai for frying - never aluminium

Niramish brinjal fritters.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
400	g	brinjal, sliced
150	g	besan (gram flour)
150	g	rice flour
1/2	tsp	kalonji (nigella)
1/2	tsp	turmeric powder
1	tsp	salt, or to taste
2	tbsp	oil

METHOD

1. Dip, fry in steel until crisp.

Mochar Chop (niramish)

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	25 min	20 min	45 min

Cookware: Steel kadhai for frying - never aluminium

Banana-flower croquettes. Skip onion; use coconut, ginger, peanuts.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
2	cups	cooked banana flower
1	-	potato
20	g	fresh ginger, crushed
100	g	fresh grated coconut
30	g	roasted peanuts
1/2	tsp	garam masala (no onion-garlic powder)
150	g	besan (gram flour)
2	tbsp	oil

METHOD

1. Mash filling, shape, crumb in batter, fry in steel.

Vegetable Chop

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	25 min	20 min	45 min

Cookware: Steel kadhai for frying - never aluminium

Beet-carrot-potato chop without onion.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
250	g	beetroot, cubed
150	g	carrot, cut
300	g	potatoes
20	g	fresh ginger, crushed
1	tsp	bhaja moshla
150	g	besan (gram flour)
2	tbsp	oil

METHOD

1. Mash, shape, fry. Serve with kasundi.

Cholar Dal

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SERVES

4

PREP

10 min

COOK

30 min

TOTAL

40 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

Chana dal with coconut and raisins. Niramish.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
100	g	chana dal, soaked
100	g	fresh grated coconut
20	g	raisins
2	leaves	bay leaves
20	g	fresh ginger, crushed
2	tblsp	ghee
1	pinch	sugar
1	tsp	salt, or to taste

METHOD

1. Cook dal. Temper whole spices, coconut, raisins. Slightly sweet.

Shukto

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	20 min	30 min	50 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

Bitter-sweet mixed veg in milk-poppy gravy - the niramish opener-main.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
600	g	bitter gourd, potato, raw banana, drumstick, beans and
4	tblsp	poppy-mustard paste
1	L	full-fat milk
1	tsp	panch phoron
2	tblsp	ghee
20	g	fresh ginger, crushed
1	tsp	salt, or to taste
100	g	sugar

METHOD

1. Fry bitter gourd first. Cook all veg with paste and milk until creamy. No onion, no garlic.

Dhokar Dalna

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	25 min	30 min	55 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

Chana-dal cakes in ginger-tomato gravy. Classic niramish.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
100	g	chana dal, soaked
2	pieces	ripe tomatoes, chopped
20	g	fresh ginger, crushed
1	tsp	cumin seeds
2	leaves	bay leaves
2	tbsp	ghee
1/2	tsp	garam masala (no onion-garlic powder)
1	tsp	salt, or to taste
1	pinch	sugar

METHOD

1. Make a tomato-ginger gravy in steel. Slide in dhoka pieces. Simmer 8 minutes.

Aloo Posto

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	10 min	20 min	30 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

Potato in poppy paste - niramish emblem.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
400	g	potatoes
4	tbsp	posto (poppy) paste
2	pieces	green chillies, slit
1/2	tsp	kalonji (nigella)
2	tbsp	mustard oil
1/2	tsp	turmeric powder
1	tsp	salt, or to taste
1	pinch	sugar

METHOD

1. Cook potatoes, add posto. Oil should shine. No peyaj, no rasun.

Labra

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	15 min	25 min	40 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

Festival mixed vegetable of Durga Puja bhog - onion-garlic free.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
300	g	pumpkin, cubed
1	tsp	panch phoron
20	g	fresh ginger, crushed
1/2	tsp	turmeric powder
1	tsp	salt, or to taste
100	g	sugar
2	tbsp	ghee

METHOD

1. Temper, add veg, cook until they melt together. Bhog style.

Lau Ghonto

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	10 min	20 min	30 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

Bottle gourd with coconut.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
400	g	lauki (bottle gourd), cubed
100	g	fresh grated coconut
1/2	tsp	kalonji (nigella)
2	leaves	bay leaves
2	tbsp	ghee
20	g	fresh ginger, crushed
1	tsp	salt, or to taste
1	pinch	sugar

METHOD

1. Cook until almost dry and sweet-savoury.

Luchi

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	20 min	15 min	35 min

Cookware: Steel kadhai for frying - never aluminium

Signature bread from West Bengal, cooked without onion or garlic.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
250	g	maida (refined flour)
2	tbsp	ghee
1	tsp	salt, or to taste
2	tbsp	oil

METHOD

- Fry until they balloon.

Radhaballavi

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	30 min	20 min	50 min

Cookware: Steel kadhai for frying - never aluminium

Urad-dal stuffed luchi, niramish spices (fennel, ginger, asafoetida).

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
250	g	maida (refined flour)
150	g	urad dal
20	g	fresh ginger, crushed
1/2	tsp	hing (asafoetida)
2	pieces	green or dry red chillies

METHOD

1. Stuff, roll, fry in steel.

Niramish Paratha

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	20 min	15 min	35 min

Cookware: Cast-iron tawa (not aluminium)

Signature bread from West Bengal, cooked without onion or garlic.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
300	g	whole-wheat atta
2	tbsp	ghee
1/2	tsp	ajwain (carom seeds)
1	tsp	salt, or to taste

METHOD

- Layered paratha on iron tawa.

Sandesh

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	15 min	15 min	30 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

Signature sweet from West Bengal, cooked without onion or garlic.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
200	g	fresh chhena
100	g	sugar
4	Pods	green cardamom, crushed

METHOD

1. Knead, cook lightly in steel, mould.

Rasgulla

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	20 min	25 min	45 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

Signature sweet from West Bengal, cooked without onion or garlic.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
200	g	fresh chhena
250	ml	sugar syrup (1-string)
4	Pods	green cardamom, crushed

METHOD

1. Boil balls in syrup in a wide steel pot until they sponge.

Chomchom

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	20 min	25 min	45 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

Oval chenna sweet in syrup, rolled in coconut or mawa.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
200	g	fresh chhena
250	ml	sugar syrup (1-string)
100	g	fresh grated coconut

METHOD

1. Cook like rasgulla, shape ovals, roll.

Payesh

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	10 min	40 min	50 min

Cookware: Heavy stainless steel milk pot - never aluminium

Signature dessert from West Bengal, cooked without onion or garlic.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
200	g	raw rice
1	L	full-fat milk
2	leaves	bay leaves
4	Pods	green cardamom, crushed
100	g	sugar

METHOD

1. Simmer in steel until creamy.

Mishti Doi

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	15 min	0 min	15 min

Cookware: Clay or glass bowl - never aluminium

Caramel-yogurt set in clay.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
1	L	full-fat milk
100	g	jaggery, grated
200	g	plain yogurt

METHOD

1. Mix, set in clay or glass. Do not set in aluminium.

Chhanar Payesh

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	15 min	25 min	40 min

Cookware: Heavy stainless steel milk pot - never aluminium

Signature dessert from West Bengal, cooked without onion or garlic.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
200	g	fresh chhena
1	L	full-fat milk
100	g	sugar
4	pods	green cardamom, crushed

METHOD

1. Simmer chenna in sweet milk in steel.

Kasundi Cucumber Salad

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	8 min	0 min	8 min

Cookware: Steel or glass bowl

Signature salad from West Bengal, cooked without onion or garlic.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
2	pieces	cucumbers
2	pieces	ripe tomatoes, chopped
1	tbsp	kasundi (mustard sauce)
1	tbsp	lemon juice
1	tsp	salt, or to taste

METHOD

1. Toss. Mustard bite instead of onion.

Tomato Khejur Relish

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	10 min	12 min	22 min

Cookware: Stainless steel kadhai or saucepan - never aluminium

Tomato-date chutney of Bengali thalis.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
2	pieces	ripe tomatoes, chopped
50	g	dates, chopped
1	tsp	panch phoron
1	tsp	panch phoron
2	pieces	green or dry red chillies
100	g	sugar
1	tsp	salt, or to taste

METHOD

1. Cook to a jammy relish.

Cucumber Lemon Salad

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SERVES	PREP	COOK	TOTAL
4	6 min	0 min	6 min

Cookware: Steel or glass bowl

Signature salad from West Bengal, cooked without onion or garlic.

INGREDIENTS · 4 servings

QTY	UNIT	INGREDIENT
2	pieces	cucumbers
1	tbsp	lemon juice
2	pieces	green chillies, slit
1	tsp	salt, or to taste
15	g	fresh coriander leaves

METHOD

1. Toss. No peyaj.